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Bing Webmaster Guidelines

These guidelines describe how Bing discovers, crawls, indexes, evaluates, and surfaces content across Bing search experiences, Copilot, and grounding API results.

Following these guidelines helps ensure your URLs are eligible for:

- Indexing and ranking
- Grounding results and citations
- Sustained visibility and qualified traffic

Failure to follow these guidelines may result in reduced visibility in Bing search, reduced eligibility for grounding experiences, or delisting from the Bing index.

1. SEO Fundamentals Still Apply to Grounding and AI Experiences

Bing and Copilot search experiences rely on the same core crawling, indexing, and ranking foundation as traditional search. SEO best practices that support discovery, indexing accuracy, and content clarity also support eligibility for AI-generated experiences, grounding results, and citations.

Practices that support:

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- Crawl efficiency
- Indexing accuracy
- URL consolidation
- Content clarity and structure
- Authority and trust signals

Also support:

- Eligibility for grounding results
- Long-term visibility across Bing, Copilot, and AI-powered search experiences.

Content that is discoverable, accurate, well-structured, and created for users performs best across all search experiences.

2. Make URLs Easy for Bing and Copilot to Discover

Bing relies on clear discovery and crawl signals to find, render, and index content accurately. Strong discovery practices help keep indexed content fresh, reliable, and eligible across Bing search and grounding experiences. Ensure Bing can reliably discover your URLs using:

- IndexNow URL submission
- XML sitemaps
- Crawlable internal links
- External links from relevant websites

Clear discovery signals improve crawl efficiency, indexing accuracy, and grounding eligibility.

3. Use Sitemaps to Signal Importance and Freshness

Use XML [sitemaps](#) to indicate which URLs matter and when content changes.

Sitemaps should:

- List only canonical URLs
- Reflect current site structure
- Remove deleted or redirected URLs promptly
- Include freshness signals (such as lastmod) where applicable

Proper sitemap usage helps Bing maintain accurate, up-to-date indexing and reliable grounding eligibility. Sitemaps do not guarantee visibility, but they significantly improve accuracy and freshness across Bing search experiences. Additionally, freshness signals like accurate lastmod values and HTTP validation headers such as ETags help Bing detect content changes more reliably.